

Julian Dehne | Resume

Research Software Engineering, Learning Technologies and Computational Social Sciences

Status: Group Lead Research Software Engineering, GI
Field: Research Software Engineering, Software Engineering, Education
Techs: Python, Scala, Java, R, Transformers

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Summary

I am a computer scientist working in Research Software Engineering (RSE). I am currently Group Lead for RSE at the Gesellschaft für Informatik (GI), where I hold the scientific direction of the Special Interest Group on Research Software Engineering, direct the national RSE master's curriculum project and lead the GI RSE Award for outstanding research software.

Before that I was a Research Software Engineer at GESIS – Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences, where I was development lead of the KODAS Toolbox, an open science platform for reusable code and reproducible tutorials, and worked on data quality standards and automated reproducibility checks.

Earlier I was a postdoctoral researcher at the University of Göttingen (social media deliberation, human-in-the-loop experiments with Reddit and Twitter, NLP with transformer models) and at Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin (machine learning for the detection of creativity in text). I did my doctorate in computer science at the University of Potsdam, where I built a framework for inquiry-based learning, algorithms for group formation, a semantic competency database and an evaluation methodology for learning technologies.

Experience

Group Lead Research Software Engineering - Gesellschaft für Informatik (GI)	since 2025
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- * Scientific direction of the Special Interest Group on Research Software Engineering (FG RSE)
- * Development of a national RSE master's curriculum (teachingRSE)
- * Project lead of the GI RSE Award and PI for the GI in FutuRSI
- * Research on research software, community building and science policy for the emerging field

Research Software Engineer - GESIS – Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences	2024 – 2025
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- * Development lead of the KODAS Toolbox, an open science platform for reusable code and reproducible tutorials
- * Research on data quality standards in the Department of Computational Social Science
- * Implementation of automated data quality and reproducibility checks

Postdoctoral Researcher - University of Göttingen	2021 – 2024
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- * Project lead and development lead of the Delab framework, Institute of Methods and Methodological Principles
- * Human-in-the-loop experiments on social media deliberation with Reddit and Twitter
- * NLP with transformer models, run in part on cluster infrastructure
- * Substitute project coordination

Postdoctoral Researcher - Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin	2020 – 2021
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- * Chair of Learning Technologies
- * Machine learning methods for the detection of creativity in text
- * Gathering and analysing large datasets from e-learning platforms

Research Assistant and Doctoral Candidate - University of Potsdam	2014 – 2020
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- * Chair of Complex Multimedia Application Architectures
- * Lead developer of the FL-Trail framework for inquiry-based learning
- * Algorithms to support group formation and a semantic database of competencies
- * Methodology for the evaluation of e-learning
- * Co-author of project proposals and reports, active member of the GI junior researcher group

Education

Dr. rer. nat. in Applied Computer Science - University of Potsdam	2014 – 2021
* Graded magna cum laude, certificate of 1 February 2021 * Thesis: Possibilities and Limitations of Media Support for Inquiry-Based Learning * Explores the use of computer technology to support inquiry-based learning in higher education (doi:10.25932/publishup-49789)	
Master of Education - University of Potsdam	2012 – 2014
* Overall grade 1.2, awarded with distinction and placed among the top graduates of the year * Two-subject degree with Computer Science as one of the two majors (alongside Political Education), grade in Computer Science 1.1 * Thesis in Computer Science: An Ontology-Based Competency Database for E-Portfolio Systems, graded 1.0	
Bachelor of Education - University of Potsdam	2009 – 2012
* Two-subject degree with Computer Science as one of the two majors * Both Potsdam degrees carry the full formal qualification to teach Computer Science at upper-secondary level (Gymnasium)	
B.A. in European Studies - University of Passau	2007 – 2009
* Certificate of 2 November 2009 * Thesis: Innenpolitische Bedingtheit europäischer Migrationspolitik * Studying the multilevel European system and how the regions influenced the Amsterdam Treaty	

Teaching Appointments

Guest Lecturer - RWTH Aachen University	since 2026
* Pilot courses of the national RSE master's curriculum (teachingRSE) * Research Methods and Methodology for Research Software Engineers * RSE Management and Communication	
Guest Lecturer - University of Potsdam	from 2026/27
* Two RSE courses, Responsible RSE and Software Evaluation * Standing in for Prof. Anna-Lena Lamprecht during her research sabbatical	
Seminars and Lectures - Universities of Potsdam and Göttingen	2014 – 2024
* Seminars and lectures on learning technologies and social science methods * Tutorials in Applied Logic and in the Didactics of Computer Science	

Service and Awards

Proceedings Editor - INFORMATIK 2026 (GI)	2026
* Editor of the proceedings of the annual conference of the Gesellschaft für Informatik, Lecture Notes in Informatics	
Programme Committee Member - deRSE26	2026
* 6th Conference for Research Software Engineering in Germany, Stuttgart	
Working Group Founder - GI Special Interest Group RSE	since 2025
* Founder of the Working Group on the Recognition of Research Software (AK Auszeichnung von Forschungssoftware) * Organiser of its annual meeting in 2026	
Programme Committee Member - CPSS at KONVENS	2024
* Workshop on Computational Linguistics for the Political and Social Sciences	

- * Conference of the Methods Section of the German Political Science Association

Programme Committee Member - DELFI

since 2019

- * The annual GI conference on educational technologies
- * Reviewing for the German learning-technologies community every year since

Best Paper Award - TU Chemnitz

2017

- * Joint 15th DeLFI (GI) and 25th GMW conference
- * Paper on digital media used for inquiry-based learning

Distinction for the Best Graduates of the Year - University of Potsdam

2014/15

- * Awarded for the Master of Education degree

Shortlisted

Professorship - TU Vienna / MPI Rostock

2023

- * Second place, TU Vienna, Faculty of Informatics
- * Fourth place, Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research, Rostock

Academic Councillor - University of Hamburg

2020

- * Second place, Department of Computer Science

Memberships

Professional Societies - Germany

- * Gesellschaft für Informatik: FG Research Software Engineering and FG E-Learning (AK Open Science)
- * Deutsche Gesellschaft für Hochschuldidaktik: AG Forschendes Lernen
- * Deutsche Vereinigung für Politikwissenschaft: Sektion Methoden

Languages

Fluent - Germany/Canada

- * German: mother tongue
- * English: fluent in spoken and written (TOEFL CBT 283/300)

Advanced - Switzerland/Peru

- * French: advanced (certificate from the University of Geneva)
- * Spanish: advanced (certificate from Maccu Picchu Spanish School)

Beginner - Germany

- * Polish: beginner (A1, UNIcert)

Classics - Germany

- * Latin: proficient (Latinum)
- * Ancient Greek: proficient (Graecum)